2.1 The Hometown Heat Map - Find the Stations That Can't Say No

Elite private strategy - not for redistribution

WAR-ROOM NOTES - 2.1 The Hometown Heat Map

GEOGRAPHY IS THE MOST UNDERUSED ADVANTAGE IN INDEPENDENT MUSIC

Labels spend 90% of radio effort on national commercial stations where the independent win rate is near zero. The winnable inventory - local, college, community, online, specialty - is almost entirely unclaimed by artists who are too proud to play the "local" card. Local is not a consolation prize. Local is the entry point to every national story: "the artist the region is talking about" travels further than "an artist who emailed us."

RING THEORY - THE DISTANCE DECAY OF ACCESS

Your probability of a "yes" from an in-person relationship beats an email-only relationship by roughly 10x, and every 30 minutes of driving expands the relationship surface: drop-ins, show tickets, guest lists, handshakes. Ring 1 (home) and Ring 2 (?1 hour) are relationship zones, not email zones. Ring 3 (?2 hours) is a hybrid: email first, drop-in on release week. Ring 4 (?300 miles) is your tour corridor: pre-roll when dates exist (Lesson 2.2). Do not pitch Ring 4 without dates. It's a waste of ammunition.

THE FOUR SEGMENTATION CUTS (IN ORDER)

- Ring - home first, always.
- Format - score it (Lesson 2.3).
- Platform - online stations add on process, not politics: fastest proof machine.
- Story - local angle, show dates, community ties. The story column is what converts a format match into a yes.

THE "CAN'T SAY NO" TRIANGLE

The perfect first target has three legs: (a) a format that fits, (b) a local story they'd be embarrassed to ignore, (c) a human contact who has seen you (or your proof). Two legs = warm. Three legs = winnable. Only map stations that have at least two legs before you spend a single drill on them.

THE MAP IS A LAND-BANK, NOT A TO-DO LIST

You will not pitch 300 stations. You will own a map of 300. The map lets you choose the right 20 today, the next 20 in 90 days, and the market you enter in 6 months - with the research already done. Build it once. Farm it forever.